

# MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 8

## Suffixes -ant & -ent



Today I am learning that the suffixes -ant and -ent often form words that describe a quality, state, person, or thing.

### 1 Learn the Meaning

The suffixes -ant and -ent often form adjectives, and sometimes nouns. They can describe a quality or state, or name a person or thing. Related word families can help with spelling.

**assistant**  
a person who assists

**dependent**  
relying on something

**resistant**  
able to resist

**persistent**  
continuing despite difficulty

### 2 Build the Word

Use the base or related word and suffix to build the new word. Notice whether it uses -ant or -ent.

| Base / related | Suffix | New word | What it describes / names |
|----------------|--------|----------|---------------------------|
| assist         | -ant   |          |                           |
| resist         | -ant   |          |                           |
| observe        | -ant   |          |                           |
| depend         | -ent   |          |                           |
| persist        | -ent   |          |                           |

### 3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

During a bridge-design challenge, each learner took a different role. Mia worked as the assistant recorder while Leo tested each material. The team needed a resistant surface for the deck, and an observant teammate noticed that one joint bent more than the others. They remained persistent, adjusting the structure and recording each result before trying again. At first, the success of the bridge seemed dependent on one strong beam. After several trials, the group created an independent support on each side and became more confident in explaining why the changes worked. They compared a resistant strip of card with a softer one and discussed how the design could tolerate small movements without breaking. When the final test was complete, Mia wrote that careful observation mattered as much as strength. The group had improved because they were persistent, compared different possibilities, and listened to one another. She also noticed a spelling pattern: many words in her report ended in -ant or -ent and belonged to related word families such as resistant/resistance and dependent/dependence.



Highlight the -ant and -ent words. Underline the base or related word when you can identify one.

### 4 Word Detective

Choose one -ant or -ent word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an -ant or -ent word from the passage.  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What base or related word can you identify?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- What does the word describe or name in this context?  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Write a related -ance or -ence noun if you can.  
\_\_\_\_\_

### 5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by their ending.

assistant   resistant   observant   tolerant  
dependent   persistent   different   confident

Ends in -ant

Ends in -ent

### 6 Use It in Writing



Complete the sentence starters.

- A persistent learner can \_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_
- Use an -ant or -ent word in your own sentence.  
\_\_\_\_\_  
\_\_\_\_\_



#### Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffixes -ant / -ent
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Connects related word families
- ☐ Spells and uses derived words



#### Capture idea:

Find an -ant or -ent word in a book or information text. Record its base or related word and explain what the word means.